

CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
CARIBBEAN SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE®
EXAMINATION

ENGLISH B

Paper 01 – General Proficiency

1 hour 45 minutes

READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS CAREFULLY.

1. This paper consists of THREE questions. Each question is worth 20 marks.
2. Answer ALL questions.
3. Write your answers in the spaces provided in this answer booklet.
4. Do NOT write in the margins.
5. You are advised to take some time to read through the paper and plan your answers.
6. If you need to rewrite any answer and there is not enough space to do so on the original page, you must use the extra lined page(s) provided at the back of this booklet. **Remember to draw a line through your original answer.**
7. **If you use the extra page(s) you MUST write the question number clearly in the box provided at the top of the extra page(s) and, where relevant, include the question part beside the answer.**

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

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1. Read the extract below carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

The CAPTAIN. BERTHA. The CAPTAIN is sitting crumpled up over the table.

BERTHA: [Going up to him]. Are you ill, Father?

CAPTAIN: [Looks up dully]. Me?

BERTHA: Do you know what you've done? Do you know you threw a lamp at Mother?

5 CAPTAIN: Did I?

BERTHA: Yes, you did! What if she'd been hurt?

CAPTAIN: What difference would that make?

BERTHA: You're not my father when you talk like that!

10 CAPTAIN: What's that you say? I'm not your father? How do you know? Who told you that? Who is your father, then? Who?

BERTHA: Well, not you, anyway!

15 CAPTAIN: Still not me! Who then? Who? You seem well informed. Who have you been talking to? That I should live to hear my own child tell me to my face I'm not her father! Don't you realize you're insulting your mother when you say that? Don't you understand that if it's true, it's to her shame?

BERTHA: Don't say anything bad about my mother, do you hear?

CAPTAIN: No, you stick together, all of you against me. You've done so all along.

BERTHA: Father!

CAPTAIN: Don't use that word again!

20 BERTHA: Father, Father!

CAPTAIN: [Pulls her to him]. Bertha, my dear, dear child, of course you're my child! Yes, yes, it can't be otherwise. It must be so!

BERTHA: No, no! I want to be myself!

CAPTAIN: Don't be afraid, my darling child, I shan't hurt you!

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- (b) How does Bertha feel about her father, the Captain? Support your answer with evidence from the extract.

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(3 marks)

- (c) Explain what the stage directions in lines 1, 3 and 27–29 reveal about the Captain.

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(3 marks)

- (d) (i) Comment on the dramatic significance of the Nurse reminding the Captain about his childhood in lines 31–41.

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(2 marks)

- (ii) Explain what the Nurse's actions in lines 31–41 reveal about her attitude towards the Captain.

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(2 marks)

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- (e) Identity ONE prop used in the extract and explain its effect on the conflict.

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(3 marks)

- (f) Comment on the effect of the Captain's statement "Caught, clipped, and double-crossed" (lines 44–45).

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(2 marks)

- (g) Suggest a title for the extract. Justify your answer with evidence from the extract.

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(3 marks)

Total 20 marks



SECTION B – POETRY

2. Read the poem below carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

Curandera¹

They think she lives alone
On the edge of town in a two-room house
where she moved when her husband died
at thirty-five of a gunshot wound
5 in the bed of another woman. The *curandera*
and house have aged together to the rhythm of the desert.

She wakes early, lights candles before
her sacred statues, brews tea of *yerbabuena*.
She moves down her porch steps, rubs
10 cool morning sand into her hands, into her arms
like a large black bird, she feeds on
the desert, gathering herbs for her basket.

Her days are slow, days of grinding
dried snake into powder, of crushing
15 wild bees to mix with white wine.
And the townspeople come, hoping
to be touched by her ointments,
her hands, her prayers, her eyes.
She listens to their stories, and she listens
20 to the desert, always, to the desert.

By sunset she is tired. The wind
strokes the strands of long gray hair,
the smell of drying plants drifts
into her blood, the sun seeps
25 into her bones. She dozes
on her back porch. Rocking, rocking.

Pat Mora,

Retrieved from <http://www.poetryfoundation.org/poem/24329>

¹ A traditional native healer in Mexico and other parts of the Spanish-speaking Americas



This image shows a full page of white paper with ten horizontal dashed lines, typical of primary-ruled notebook paper. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There is no handwriting or other markings on the paper.

(b) What does “she lives alone / On the edge of town” (lines 1–2) suggest about the curandera?

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(c) Identify the figurative device used in ONE of the following and comment on its effectiveness:

- “like a large black bird, she feeds on / the desert” (lines 11–12)
- “The wind / strokes the strands of long gray hair” (lines 21–22)

[illegible]

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- (d) Comment on the poet's use of imagery in stanza 3.

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(3 marks)

- (e) Identify the speaker's attitude towards the curandera. Select TWO pieces of evidence from the poem to support your answer.

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(3 marks)

- (f) Identify ONE example of contrast in the poem and show how the poet uses this contrast to make the poem interesting.

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(3 marks)

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- (g) What impressions are created of the curandera's situation in the last stanza? Support your answer with evidence from the last stanza.

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(3 marks)

Total 20 marks

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SECTION C – PROSE FICTION

3. Read the extract below carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

Everyone knew Ma; she lived just down the road next to Mr Smith's corner rum shop. She was a small, short woman, but had a temperament some said was like a force of nature, unconquerable. Ma's house was like her in many ways. It wasn't an architectural wonder but it had character.

- 5 Joe "Fishcake" Brown (so called because of his insatiable craving for the tidbit) was propping up against the rum shop door, pelting back a beer, declaring loudly that there was nothing that anyone could dare him to do that he couldn't do. Mr Smith in a sly manner, belted out a challenge. Fishcake boldly accepted. The shop went dead silent.

- 10 A week after the bet, I saw a head poke through Ma's unlocked back door. It was Fishcake, dressed in all black (in broad daylight, mind you) and wearing dark sunglasses. From a large pocket in his pants Fishcake pulled out a folded knapsack and glanced around. He searched the drawers and closets, dropping everything of value into his knapsack.

- 15 Instead of making his escape, Fishcake headed for the kitchen. Resting his heavy knapsack on the counter, he opened the fridge door and took out a bottle of water. He was about to close the door when something else caught his eye — a cling wrap covered bowl, filled to the brim with fishcake batter. The kitchen was soon filled with the delicious aroma of fishcakes, and the little ball of batter danced merrily in the oil accompanied by the usual frying noises.

- 20 Ma sniffed the air. A frown puckered her forehead and a puzzled look settled on her brown, aged features. Ma moved slowly and quietly towards the kitchen. Spying Fishcake, she moved back a few steps into the hallway, and flattened herself to one side. When I saw her again she was holding a rolling pin.

- 25 With a big smile on his face and humming a little tune, Fishcake engrossed himself in dabbing his golden brown fishcakes with a paper towel. Grabbing the one closest to hand, he was about to take the first bite when Ma snuck up behind him. Holding the rolling pin above her head, Ma carried it up and brought it down.

Ma ran outside and came back with a long piece of rope. Pushing Fishcake on his stomach, she tied his two hands together behind his back. Bending both feet at the knees so that they could reach his hands, she secured them too. Now satisfied that he could not escape, Ma left Fishcake trussed-up like a turkey and went to call the police.

- 30 As you can imagine, the boys from the shop were the first to gather at the scene.

*Adapted from Shirnelle Blackman, "Ma's House."
In The Hole and Other Barbadian Poems and Short Stories:
A Winning Words Anthology, National Cultural Foundation, 2004, pp. 119–123.*

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- (a) State THREE things we learn about Ma in paragraph 1.

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(3 marks)

- (b) Comment on the effectiveness of “dressed in all black (in broad daylight, mind you) and wearing dark sunglasses” (line 10).

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(2 marks)

- (c) (i) Why did Fishcake remain in the house after he took the items?

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(1 mark)

- (ii) What does the reason identified in (b) (i) above suggest about Fishcake’s character?

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(2 marks)

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- (d) How does Ma's behaviour in lines 21–28 ("she was holding a rolling pin . . . call the police") make the extract humorous?

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(3 marks)

- (e) Identify the figurative device in "trussed-up like a turkey" (line 29) and comment on its effectiveness.

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(3 marks)

- (f) (i) Comment on the significance of the rum shop in the extract.

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(2 marks)



- (ii) Suggest how the boys in the shop might respond to Fishcake's predicament.

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(2 marks)

- (g) Identify ONE theme in the extract. Support your answer with evidence from the extract.

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(2 marks)

Total 20 marks

END OF TEST

IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS TEST.

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